



One of the few online travel portals that offer information and the option of booking your trip online is TravelJini.com

Plan Your Trip

A package tour is something where your itinerary is planned to the 't' by the travel agency, and all you need to do is show up. And of course, pay up!

Doing this online is also a realistic option today. Whether it's a reputed tour organiser or a dedicated online portal, you can go online and choose a package that fits your budget, time schedule and destination.

Portals such as Traveljini (<http://traveljini.com>) let you plan a trip or choose from one of their many packages. Often, they also have a variety of great promotional offers, and if they are running when you are planning, there couldn't be anything better.

In fact, Traveljini had a \$49-99 deal that offered some packages (3 Days/2 Nights and more) for either \$49 (Rs 2,300) or \$99 (Rs 4,650). Sound great? Well, it almost is!

One catch in planning a trip this way is there's a lot of fine print involved that simply must be read. In the case of the trips mentioned above, the prices were per head per day, and the package did not include airfare! So a trip to Singapore for 3 Days and 2 Nights for two people would cost about \$1,025 (Rs 48,178). Here's how we arrived at this figure:

Cost of stay as specified by Traveljini: \$49 per head per day

Duration of stay: 3 Days 2 Nights

Payable days: 3

[A] Total cost of stay:

$\$49 \times 3 \times 2 = \294 (Rs 13,818)

Remember, this does not include the airline costs. We checked up on <http://jetairways.com> for their Mumbai-Singapore flight. We asked for two economy

Gadgets To Carry

CELL PHONES

HP iPAQ hw6515 Mobile Messenger

For those who wander around the globe, the new iPAQ hw6515 Mobile Messenger is the perfect travelling companion. One of the latest PDA phones launched by HP, the hw6515 Mobile Messenger lives true to its name and keeps you connected wherever you are.

Featuring a quad-band GSM phone (850/900/1800/ 1900 MHz), the device also supports GPRS/EDGE technologies that provide high-speed connectivity. Boasting of an internal GPS receiver, the iPAQ hw6515 (coupled with GPS software and digital city maps) is capable of pinpointing your exact location and provide you with turn-by-turn driving instructions to your destination.

What's more, you also get a 1.3 megapixel HP Photosmart Camera built into the device, so you can capture both still images and videos and share them instantly using MMS or e-mail.

Price: Rs 29,000 (plus taxes)

DIGITAL CAMERAS

Sony DSC P200

There's a reason we think that the Sony DSC P200 would be a good travel companion. For one, it has a massive 7.1-megapixel CCD, and it is feature rich. You can easily drop it into your pocket and move on whenever required.

Moreover, it has all the features a serious photographer would want. When travelling, you'd prefer a camera that starts up almost instantly and is ready to shoot before you lose the moment. This is the one.

Price: Rs 20,990



Nikon Coolpix 5900

If small yet powerful cameras are your thing, this is a great piece to have. With a 5.1-megapixel CCD, a variety of flash modes and great features, this camera will not disappoint.

The Coolpix 5900 also boasts of 3X optical zoom and some digital zoom. In terms of its performance, the 5900 is a reliable camera with good colour reproduction and optical clarity.

Price: Rs 21,000

CAMCORDERS

Samsung DuoCam

With a MiniDV camcorder for high quality recording and 5.2 mp digicam crisp images, the DuoCam lets you choose how you want to capture. It has two lenses and CCD image sensors ensuring high clarity and quality for all photos and video clips.

Price: Rs 25,000



Sony DCR HC42E

This compact little camcorder is equipped with a 1/5.5" megapixel CCD and a CZ Vario-Tessar lens and will probably deliver the best image quality you could ask for. The DCR HC42E also has a 12X optical zoom lens and can zoom up to 480X in digital zoom more.

Ease of use is high thanks to the touch panel for all operations and the newest added technology-Easy Handycam. What's that? Using this function, all settings are automated, making it possible to just point and shoot!

Storage options include a Memory Stick DUO Slot, especially useful for the digital still camera. Priced very well, this is a camera that can be a good companion on your travels.

Price: Rs 34,995